

OPTIONAL HELP

Use one hint at a time.

Return to the records as soon as a hint gives you a next step. The original hint levels and exhibit references remain unchanged in this edition.

If a scene has made you certain about somebody, ask which record supports that certainty. Caring about a person, distrusting them, or finding their explanation plausible is not a substitute for a link in the evidence.

The story can leave a motive complicated while the record answers a factual question. You are allowed to reach a firm identification and still disagree about the person involved.

The following pages retain their original hint folios. Read progressively. Keep the separate sealed solution closed until you have committed your answer.

Optional hints

Open only when you want a nudge.

The next three pages give progressively more specific help. You can solve the case without using them.

PAGE 34 / A DIRECTION

Questions that help you choose a useful next step.

PAGE 35 / A RECORD TO OPEN

Specific record combinations for common sticking points.

PAGE 36 / A STRONGER NUDGE

Direct comparisons that nearly resolve the investigation.

Start with page 34. If one hint unsticks you, return to the papers before reading farther. Cover the lower part of a hint page with a blank sheet if you want to reveal one item at a time.

A direction

Read only as far as you need.

THE FIRST HOUSEHOLD

Read both Mabel's relationship and Edith's childbearing fields. Does the word daughter tell you everything you need?

THE CLIPPING

Separate the day the newspaper appeared from the day the child was found. Work backward from the physician's approximate age.

THE CANDIDATES

Use the birth index to build a short list. A familiar first name may attract attention, but it cannot finish the investigation.

THE FAMILY CHANGE

Compare a household before the basket with households afterward. If a child disappears from one home, search for a positive entry somewhere else.

THE FINAL EXPLANATION

You can have a well-supported identity without knowing who carried the basket. Do not turn an unnamed person in a newspaper report into a named witness.

A record to open

These combinations are more specific.

LINK THE SUTTONS TO THE CHURCH

Compare BB01, BB02, and BB20. The care book connects the found infant to the Sutton home without naming her birth family.

FIX THE BIRTH SEARCH

BB02 reports about seven months on September 30, 1900. Look through BB04 and then BB18. The estimate is not an exact cutoff; keep all four candidates in play until you trace them.

LOOK FOR A CRISIS

BB09 contains three mothers' death entries. Which death falls immediately before September 30? Which falls after it? Do not stop with the dates: test the children's later whereabouts.

TRACE A SURNAME ACROSS HOUSEHOLDS

Put BB07 beside BB10, BB11, BB12, and BB14. Copy the names before interpreting the labels. BB19 helps you investigate one connection through the maiden name Flynn.

FINISH THE OTHER SEARCHES

For Elsie Miller open BB15. For Nora Keane open BB16. For Ruth Foster open BB17. Compare each record with the corresponding 1900 household.

A stronger nudge

Return to the evidence after each comparison.

THE FAMILY TO EXAMINE

BB07 has ten children, including an infant girl born in February 1900. BB18 gives her exact birthday and her parents' names.

THE EIGHT-DAY INTERVAL

Compare Nora Reilly's death on September 22 with the finding on September 30. The household loses its mother immediately before the basket appears.

NAMES IN OTHER HOMES

John Reilly is in the Walsh household; Margaret in the Doyle household; Thomas in the Bennett household; Rose in the O'Brien household. Compare their names and ages with BB07.

WHY THE ALTERNATIVES WEAKEN

Elsie is positively recorded as Rebecca Hale's granddaughter in 1910. Nora remains in the Keane household. Ruth is named with Samuel Foster in the Indiana departure notice. None needs to become Mabel Sutton to explain her later record.

WHAT TO SUBMIT

Name the February-born infant in the ten-child household. Explain the converging age, death, and dispersal evidence. Leave the identity of the person who brought the basket unconfirmed until the sealed family paper.